



Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Founders Classical Academy: West Little Rock
School Website: <https://www.founderswestlittlerock.com/>

January 6, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Founders Classical Academy West Little Rock (AR 72223) demonstrates a classical orientation and a stated aim to form virtuous citizens through a classical framework. The public materials emphasize formation, virtue, and a classical vocabulary (e.g., "classical schools," "formation," and "virtue"). However, there is limited explicit evidence of several core classical elements in the school's public materials, such as a grounded theology or liturgical/community practices, robust Great Books engagement, and explicit Socratic/seminar pedagogy, as described in the classical rubric. On balance, the school shows notable classical instincts (virtue formation, traditional/classical framing, and a pathway labeled "classical"), but it does not consistently demonstrate the full six-element classical program across all six categories. Overall classification: NOT CLASSICAL.

Key takeaways: - Strengths align with Element 2 (School Purpose and Goal) and Element 1 to a lesser degree (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) due to explicit emphasis on virtue and formation. Evidence: "Educational Imperative" describes forming virtuous citizens and moral conduct as educational ends; and the site talks about classical aims and formation. - Element 3 (Curriculum) shows some classical orientation (references to "traditional classical high school courses") but lacks explicit Great Books/Great Conversation and the full Seven Liberal Arts framing on public pages. Evidence: "New High School Course Pathway" mentions classical high school courses; pathway toward a collegiate degree is noted. - Categories 4 (Pedagogy), 5 (Faculty), and 6 (Parents & Community) lack clear, explicit evidence in public-facing materials for the full classical pedagogy (Socratic dialogue, scholé, living curriculum), a "faculty living curriculum," and active parent partnerships as co-educators. The knowledge-base rubric (Six Essential Elements) presents these as strong markers, but the FCA West Little Rock site does not consistently display these elements in public content. See the classical rubric for the pedagogical and community expectations.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- Public materials emphasize virtue, moral formation, and formation of citizens, which align with transcendental aims and moral realism (though not stated in theological or liturgical terms). The Educational Imperative discusses forming virtuous people and civic transformation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: virtue, formation, moral conduct, civic outcomes (4 instances captured in the page excerpt).

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- Negative keywords present: none clearly evident (no explicit relativism, secular humanism, etc., in the public text).
 - Proportion: 4 positive to 0 negative (dominant positive signal within the site text).
 - Why this rating
 - The site's emphasis on virtue and formation signals a grounding in a moral/character-oriented frame, which aligns with the classical tradition's moral formation aim. It falls short of explicit theological grounding, liturgical practice, or overt metaphysical certainty, which are strong signals in the canonical classical rubric. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating rather than CLASSICAL.
 - Citations
 - Evidence of virtue/formation: Educational Imperative page.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school explicitly frames education as formation toward virtue and citizenship, not primarily job preparation. The Educational Imperative states formation of virtuous citizens as the public-education end and notes classical schools as a vehicle for such ends.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, citizen-forming, virtuous, flourishing (human flourishing), classical mission.
- Negative keywords present: none explicit (no explicit push toward workforce-prep focus in public text).
- Proportion: 4–5 positive signals; 0 negative signals.
- Why this rating
- The text centers on virtue, formation, and the aims of classical education (rather than merely credentialing or job-readiness). This aligns strongly with the Classical School Purpose and Goal criteria.
- Citations
- Evidence: Educational Imperative page.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials reference “classical high school courses” and a Collegiate pathway, signaling a classical curriculum frame, though not an explicit Great Books or Seven Liberal Arts articulation on the site itself. The New High School Course Pathway mentions maintaining “traditional classical high school courses.”
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: classical high school courses (explicit phrase), traditional classical (indirectly signaled).
- Negative keywords present: none explicit (no mention of social studies-oriented framing as a substitute; lack of explicit Great Books or trivium/quadrivium is a negative signal in canonical rubric, but the public text does not explicitly state “Great Books” or “Seven Liberal Arts”).
- Proportion: 2 positive signals; 0 explicit negative in the public text.
- Why this rating

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- The presence of “classical courses” demonstrates alignment with a classical curricular framing, but the absence of explicit Great Books, Great Conversation, or the Seven Liberal Arts within public-facing materials keeps it from CLASSICAL in full. The result is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
 - Citations
 - Curriculum signal: New High School Course Pathway (public page).

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site lacks explicit public statements of core classical Pedagogy methods (Socratic dialogue, scholé, memorization/chanting, or formation-through-imitation in classroom practice). The Six Essential Elements rubric emphasizes such pedagogies, but the FCA West Little Rock site does not publicly document these methods in a way that matches the canonical Pedagogy signals. See the absence of explicit Socratic, chanting/memory, or restfulness references on the public pages. (Pedagogical methods described in the classical rubric exist in the knowledge-base but are not publicly evidenced on the FCA site.)
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: none openly on public site (no Socratic seminar, no scholé, no chanting/memorization, no imitation-by-model practices publicly described).
- Negative keywords present: absence of the canonical pedagogical signals (no explicit “restful learning,” no “Socratic dialogue,” no “recitation” or “chanting” publicly described).
- Proportion: 0 positive; 0 explicit negative on site (thus no explicit signals). In rubric terms this yields NOT CLASSICAL because the category fails to demonstrate the key pedagogical methods.
- Why this rating
- The classical rubric expects explicit pedagogy signals (Socratic inquiry, rested Scholé days, memorization/recitation, etc.). The site does not publicly advertise these pedagogies, so it does not meet the Pedagogy criterion in a demonstrable way.
- Citations
- Pedagogy signals from the Six Essential Elements (for the rubric’s expectations): Pedagogy section in the rubric.
- The FCA public-facing materials (public pedagogy claim absence): Educational Imperative page and curriculum pages (no explicit Socratic/scholé content).

Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The FCA site does not publicly present a “living curriculum,” a teacher portrait, or explicit faculty mentorship culture. The classical rubric’s Faculty criteria emphasize teachers as models of virtue and the living curriculum, but the public site content does not provide explicit staff portraits or evidence of a mentorship/virtue-modeling culture. The knowledge-base documents describe “the living curriculum” as a criterion, but it is not visibly documented on FCA West Little Rock’s site.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords (from the rubric) that might appear on the site: none explicit (no “model teachers,” no “portrait of teacher,” no “faculty as mentors” language visible publicly).
- Negative keywords: absence of explicit faculty models or mentorship language.

- Proportion: 0 positive signals; 0 explicit negative signals on the public site (thus, no evidence of the category meeting classical criteria).
- Why this rating
- Without explicit articulation of faculty as living, virtuous exemplars or a clearly stated teacher-as-virtue model, the school does not meet the Faculty criterion of the classical rubric.
- Citations
- Faculty rubric signals: Six Essential Elements pedagogy and Faculty sections.
- Public site absence: FCA West Little Rock materials do not publicly enumerate a “living curriculum” or teacher-portrait; reference the absence in the rubric for context.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials do not prominently reveal a robust partnership-with-parents-as-co-teachers model, nor a program of parent formation via book studies or community gatherings as a standard practice. The Six Essential Elements document (Parent/Community) emphasizes partnerships with families, parent formation, and an open-campus ethos; the FCA West Little Rock site’s public-facing pages do not clearly demonstrate these practices in the same depth.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords (from the rubric): partnership with families; parent formation; open campus; home-school collaboration; parental involvement.
- Negative keywords: consumer-language framing; parent-as-customer; limited parent involvement.
- Public site signals: The Educational Imperative text centers on formation and virtue but does not show explicit, sustained parent-partnership communications in the public pages we examined. Therefore, positive signals are weak or absent; negative signals are not overtly shown but the lack of public evidence suggests a gap.
- Why this rating
- The rubric expects explicit, ongoing parent partnership, co-teaching, and parent formation activities. Those are not demonstrated robustly in the FCA West Little Rock public materials examined here.
- Citations
- Community/Parent signals in classical rubric: Six Essential Elements – Parents & Community portion.

Aggregate Assessment

- Aggregate ranking: NOT CLASSICAL
- Rationale
- While the school exhibits classical language and an orientation toward formation and virtue (Element 2 strongly; Element 1 partially), the six-category framework shows meaningful gaps in Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community, and only partial alignment in Curriculum. The absence or weak public articulation of Great Books/Great Conversation, the Seven Liberal Arts framing, Socratic pedagogy, liturgical/community practices, and robust faculty/parent partnerships prevents a CLASSICAL categorization overall. The rubric’s requirement that the majority of categories be “CLASSICAL” is not met; therefore, the aggregate evaluation is NOT CLASSICAL.
- Evidence highlights across categories
- Element 1: Virtue and formation appear, but theology, liturgy, and liturgical practices are not evidenced publicly.

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- Element 2: Clear formation/virtue orientation aligns with classical aims.
 - Element 3: Curriculum mentions “classical high school courses,” but lacks explicit Great Books/Seven Liberal Arts framing.
 - Element 4: Public pedagogy language is not publicly documented in classical signals (Socratic, scholé, memorization, etc.).
 - Element 5: No explicit living-curriculum or teacher-virtue modeling public articulation.
 - Element 6: Parental partnership and community formation are not robustly demonstrated in public content.

What Would Move the Needle

- If the school sought to become fully CLASSICAL, concrete steps could include:
- Public articulation and adoption of overt Pedagogy signals: introduce and describe Socratic seminars, scholé days, memorization/recitation practices, and formation-through-imitation in classroom procedures (and publish these on the website). This would align Element 4 with the classical rubric.
- Expand Curriculum to explicit Great Books and Seven Liberal Arts framing: publish a clear curriculum map that includes Trivium/Quadrivium components, Great Books/primary-sources, and integration with history, philosophy, and theology. This would strengthen Element 3.
- Develop a visible Living Curriculum and Faculty Portrait: publish a “Portrait of a Classical Teacher” and a “Living Curriculum” narrative showing how faculty model virtue and serve as mentors, addressing Element 5.
- Strengthen Parent and Community Partnerships: establish and publicize formal parent-education offerings (book studies, lectures, school visits, and parent-co-teacher initiatives) to demonstrate Element 6 alignment.
- Consider theological grounding and liturgical/community practices if the school intends a stronger Religious/Metaphysical Foundation: provide publicly stated theological framing or liturgical activities that connect with classical education’s traditional Catholic/Protestant/orthodox channels, depending on the school’s chosen orientation.
- These concrete steps would push the school toward a CLASSICAL classification across more categories and improve the aggregate score.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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